

Town of Westwood
Commonwealth of Massachusetts

John Rogers, Chairman
Stephen David
Helen Gordon
Vesna Maneva
R.J. Sheer
Todd Sullivan
Todd Weston



Karon Skinner Catrone, Conservation Agent
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CONSERVATION COMMISSION

Minutes: Conservation Commission Meeting Date: October 14, 2020 at 7:00 p.m.

Location: Remote Meeting

7:00 p.m. – Call to Order

Ms. Gordon states the Westwood Conservation Commission meeting of **Wednesday October 14, 2020 at 7:00 PM. is being held** through Zoom due to the COVID-19 state of emergency and in compliance with the Governor's March 12, 2020 Order suspending certain provisions of the Open Meeting Law MGL C. 30A, §18 and the Governor's March 23 Emergency Order imposing limitations on the number of people that may gather in one place. This meeting is being recorded.

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The following members are present: Helen Gordon, Vesna Maneva, R.J. Sheer, John Rogers, Todd Weston and Todd Sullivan. Member Stephen David was absent. Conservation Agent, Karon Skinner Catrone was present.

Ms. Gordon states the applicant for 42 Mill Street has requested a continuance to the October 28, 2020 meeting. **Motion made by Mr. Sullivan, seconded by Mr. Rogers to continue the hearing for 42 Mill Street to the October 28, 2020 meeting.**

Approval of Minutes:

Consideration of minutes for meeting of March 25, 2020, April 8, 2020, April 22, 2020, May 27, 2020, June 10, 2020, June 24, 2020 and July 8, 2020, July 22, 2020, September 9, 2020 and September 23, 2020.

Motion made by Mr. Sullivan, seconded by Ms. Gordon to table the minutes to the meeting of October 28, 2020. Unanimous.

Request for Certificate of Compliance – 906 Gay Street – DEP - #338-0677 - The Commission opened the public hearing and reviewed copies of the request for Certificate of Compliance for DEP #338-0677, including the following:

1. Letter of significant compliance, dated 3/23/2020, from Matthew Smith of Norwood Engineering, 1410 Route One, Norwood, MA 02026, including one (1) page;
2. As-built Plan titled "ASBUILT PLAN OF LAND IN WESTWOOD, MASS." dated March 12, 2020, stamped and signed by Matthew Smith of Norwood Engineering, including one (1) page;
3. WPA Form 8A – Request for Certificate of Compliance, including two (2) pages;

Ms. Catrone states she inspected the site on 10/14/2020. The rear of the lot was not stabilized and the driveway was not paved. She recommends the Commission continue this request and she will speak with the owner.

Motion made by Mr. Sullivan, seconded by Mr. Sheer to continue this hearing to the October 28, 2020 meeting. Unanimous.

Hearings:

Public Hearings:

13 Stonemeadow Drive – Notice of Intent - DEP #338-0710 – Joyce – continued from 9/23/2020

This hearing was continued from the September 23, 2020 meeting to allow the project to be reviewed by Phil Paradis as requested by the Planning Board. Mr. Paradis is present. The Commission opened the public hearing and reviewed the comments from the peer review consultant, including the following:

1. Review letter from Philip Paradis titled “13 Stonemeadow Drive Land Disturbance (Stormwater) Peer Review”, dated 6/29/2020

Present is Jeffrey Murphy, PE, Project Manager from Beals and Thomas of 144 Turnpike Road, Southborough, MA 01772, representing Old Grove Partners of P.O. Box 920358, Needham, MA 02494.

Mr. Paradis states the applicant has added a number of stormwater features as mitigation. NRCS rates these soils as A soils, which he agrees with. Regarding the infiltration, he would like to see roof runoff and pavement runoff in separate systems. The roof system will have a longer life.

Mr. Murphy states by directing the entire driveway to a separate system we will have to make the system larger and there will be more disturbance to the buffer zone.

Mr. Paradis states this site is wooded and has A soils. A soils have limited amount of runoff. It is better to use physical data in this situation.

Mr. Murphy asks why he would disregard NRCS which is not site specific. Mr. Murphy discusses the proposed drainage design on the site.

Mr. Rogers asks if the system is designed for a 1” or 2” storm.

Mr. Murphy states the proposed system has low runoff. It is difficult to get to zero. The design is for more than 1”.

Mr. Rogers asks that the applicant provide calculations. If the design is not for more than 1” then the systems must be made deeper or larger.

Ms. Maneva asks if the applicant is using pavers where it is possible.

Mr. Murphy states they would like to stay with the pavement as designed.

Mr. Antonelli, potential owner, states the Commission is not seeing the human side of this.

Mr. Rogers states that the commission is looking at the human side. We are all volunteers trying to do the best job we can.

Ms. Gordon explains that we do not want to see your project impact the wetland or the abutters.

Motion made by Mr. Rogers, seconded by Ms. Maneva, to accept this plan and issue an Order of Conditions conditional on the receipt of the drainage calculations and that these calculations provide greater than 1” of storage. Unanimous.

367 Fox Hill Street – Stormwater Notice of Intent - SMP # –

The Commission opened the public hearing and reviewed copies of the Stormwater Notice of Intent for 367 Fox Hill Street, including the following:

1. Land Disturbance Permit Application dated September 29, 2020, submitted by Joyce Hastings of GLM Engineering Consultants of 19 Exchange Street, Holliston, MA 01746, including eleven (11) pages;
2. “PROPOSED SITE PLAN 367 Fox Hill Street, Westwood, Massachusetts” dated March 12, 2020, stamped and signed by Matthew Smith of Norwood Engineering, including one (1) page;

Present is Joyce Hastings of GLM Engineering Consultants representing David Parrish of Sherborn Development Group LLC, 1 Taylor Lane, Dover, MA 02030.

Ms. Hastings states the site is currently a vacant 3.35 acre lot and on the west side of Fox Hill Street. The lot was subdivided from a larger parcel in 2019 and contains retaining walls, fencing, overgrown paddocks and woods.

The applicant is proposing the construction of a single family dwelling toward the middle of the property. The project includes the house, driveway, retaining walls, associated grading and utilities. The area to be disturbed is 43,560 sq. ft. No fill will be brought in. A portion of the lot is an orchard, which will remain. We will be recharging 1 inch of rain with two infiltration systems. We are showing a trench along the downgradient side of the driveway. Thirty (30) trees will be planted along the edge of the property.

Ms. Maneva states the proposed trees are small at 1.5 inches.

Ms. Gordon states we typically like to see roof leaders to systems shown on the plan.

Harry Treant of 377 Fox Hill Street expresses concern regarding water going on his property.

Violations: 121 Cedar Lane – Applicant is working with Site Design Professionals

Discussion Items:

1. Commissioners' observations around town and next scheduled site visits
2. Current significant projects
3. Reserved for topics not reasonably anticipated to be discussed
4. Actively make buyers, property owners and realtors aware of WPA, wetland ordinance and stormwater ordinance
5. Brief Select Board on Concom and need for Conservation Land Management Plan

Upcoming Meeting: 10/28/2020 REMOTE PARTICIPATION

Note: Agenda items and order subject to change

Mr. David recuses himself from this hearing.

Motion made by Mr. Sullivan, seconded by Mr. Sheer, to adjourn the meeting. Unanimous.